GrowRice with PaymentsPlus by Westpac

GrowRice helps approved growers access funding for eligible CY27 rice crop inputs, including water. Growers register through Westpac PaymentsPlus, submit eligible invoices to Grower Services and release the approved net funds to their nominated bank account before paying the supplier directly.

1. How GrowRice operates

GrowRice is a crop input funding facility for approved growers. PaymentsPlus is the Westpac online platform used for registration, identity checks, payment availability and the release of funds.

- Funding may be used for approved rice crop inputs, including water, fertiliser and pesticides.
- Grower Services checks each funding request and enables the approved amount to be made available in PaymentsPlus.
- The grower logs into Payment Plus and releases the approved amount to their nominated bank account and pays the supplier directly.
- The advance is repaid from the grower's earliest available CY27 Fixed Price Contract payment proceeds.

Important: *SunRice does not pay the supplier. The grower remains responsible for paying the full supplier invoice after the net funds are deposited into their nominated bank account.*

2. Eligibility

GrowRice is approved on a case-by-case basis. The CY27 approval criteria include:

- The grower supplied rice to SunRice in CY24, CY25 or CY26.
- The grower achieved at least 75% of the regional average yield for the variety or varieties grown in the relevant years of delivery.
- The grower has completed the GrowRice Grower Undertaking for the relevant hectares.
- The hectares included in the Grower Undertaking are hectares the grower is committed to growing through to harvest.

Growers without recent supply history: *If the grower has not supplied rice to SunRice in at least one of the past three crop years, funding is only made available after a crop inspection confirms the approved hectares have been sown and the crop is satisfactorily established with the potential to achieve at least 75% of the Regional Varietal Average.*

Do not overcommit hectares: *Matilda (V071) and Sherpa hectares that may be cancelled during the Opt-Out Period must not be included in the GrowRice Grower Undertaking. Grower Services can review and increase your credit limit later if additional hectares are planted and confirmed.*

3. How much can a grower access?

The CY27 facility offers an advance of up to $3,000 per approved hectare. The final credit limit depends on the hectares approved by SunRice and confirmed in the Grower Undertaking.

4. Sign-up and approval process

1. **Contact Grower Services:** Call 1800 654 557 and ask to apply for GrowRice. A GrowRice Grower Undertaking will be emailed.
2. **Receive the invitation:** Grower Services arranges a Westpac PaymentsPlus invitation.
3. **Create the PaymentsPlus login:** Confirm business details, accept the terms, verify the email address, add mobile security and create a password.
4. **Start the identity check:** In PaymentsPlus select the red button 'Begin Identification Process' at the bottom of the Identity tab to begin Westpac's Know Your Customer (KYC) process.
5. **Provide documents (if requested):** Westpac may request identification records, trust deeds or other business documents, depending on the business structure.
6. **Return the Grower Undertaking:** Confirm the hectares committed to GrowRice and return the signed undertaking to growerservices@sunrice.com.au.
7. **Approval and limit setup:** Once Westpac's checks and SunRice requirements are complete, the approved credit limit is established.

Allow time for onboarding: *Westpac cannot begin KYC until the grower starts the identification process from the Identity tab. The process may take longer when extra business or trust documents are needed.*

5. Using GrowRice once approved

1. **Arrange the purchase**: Agree on an eligible rice crop input purchase with your supplier.
2. **Send the invoice**: Email the invoice to growerservices@sunrice.com.au. For same-day processing where possible, send it before 12:00 pm.
3. **Grower Services reviews it**: Grower Services checks that the request is eligible and enables the approved amount to be made available to you via PaymentsPlus.
4. **Payment becomes available**: PaymentsPlus emails you when the payment is available, provided notifications are enabled.
5. **Release the funds**: You sign in to PaymentsPlus, select the payment and release the discounted amount to your nominated bank account.
6. **Pay the supplier**: You pay the full supplier invoice. PaymentsPlus sends a remittance showing the invoice and the discount details.
7. **Repay funding**: The advance will be repayable from the earliest available CY27 Fixed Price Contract payment proceeds.

6. What is the cost of accessing GrowRice

There is no application fee or ongoing monthly interest charges.

In PaymentsPlus, "discounting" means you can access your approved invoice amount early. When the grower selects an available invoice, Westpac applies the relevant discount and deposits the net amount into the grower's nominated bank account. There are no continuing interest charges applied to your account; any interest is recognised up front in the discount amount.

- **Invoice amount:** the amount of the supplier invoice approved for funding.
- **Discount amount:** the financing cost deducted through PaymentsPlus when the payment is released. This is BBSY plus a margin.
- **Net amount released to the grower:** the invoice amount less the discount amount.
- **Supplier obligation:** the grower must still pay the supplier's full invoice amount.
- **Remittance:** PaymentsPlus provides a remittance showing the invoice amount and discount amount.

Example: *If an approved invoice is $100,000, the amount deposited will be $100,000 less the discount calculated by Westpac. The grower then pays the supplier the full $100,000. The actual discount depends on the applicable PaymentsPlus terms shown for the transaction.*

7. Pre-sowing water requirements

- Water purchased before sowing must be intended for the CY27 rice crop.
- The grower must transfer the water, or instruct the seller to transfer it, to the relevant SunRice water account as security for the advance.
- The invoice must show the water vendor, volume purchased and amount due.
- All the funded water is available to be returned to the grower's account after a Seed Order is placed.

8. Repayment and responsibilities

- GrowRice advances are repaid from the earliest available CY27 Fixed Price Contract payment proceeds.
- The grower remains liable for any GrowRice balance not covered by CY27 Fixed Price Contract payment proceeds.
- The Grower Undertaking includes obligations relating to planting, delivery, water, security interests and crop performance.

9. Will GrowRice impact on my other lending facilities?

GrowRice does not replace Grower Deduction Authorities (GDA) or seed purchase on credit terms. These facilities will continue to be available; however, growers should note that Grower Services will continue to monitor grower exposure to total credit facilities (GrowRice/GDAs/seed purchase on credit terms).

10. Contact

If you have any questions or require assistance, please contact Grower Services on 1800 654 557 or growerservices@sunrice.com.au

Important: *Growers should read the current Grower Undertaking and Westpac terms and conditions documents which govern approval, pricing, facility availability and the grower's obligations.*